AFRICAN YOUTH
BASEBALL & SOFTBALL
EMPOWERMENT FOUNDATION

REPORT ON

KIDS' BASEBALL, SOFTBALL, STEAM SUMMER CAMP AND ART COMPETITION 2024

www.aybsef.org
aybsef@aybsef.org

Ground Floor
23 Venerable Adefila Street, G.R.A, Off Lajorin,
Ilorin, Kwara State, Nigeria, Africa.
08036014972, 07036261450, 09023556747

TABLE OF CONTENTS

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY 1

INTRODUCTION 2

OBJECTIVES 3

SNAPSHOT OF DAILY ACTIVITIES 4

OVERVIEW OF THE EVENT 6

MONITORING AND EVALUATION 8

LEARNINGS 9

TRAINING TEAM 10

VOLUNTEERS AND COACHES 11

GALLERY 12

ABBREVIATIONS

AI: Artificial Intelligence

AYBSEF: African Youth Baseball and Softball Empowerment Foundation

NBSA: Nigeria Baseball and Softball Association

STEAM: Science, Technology, Engineering, Arts and Mathematics

1.0

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The African Youth Baseball and Softball Empowerment Foundation (AYBSEF) organized a two-week bootcamp tagged "Kids' Baseball, Softball, and STEAM Summer Camp 2024" from August 12th to 23rd, 2024, at Baseball Park, Adewole, Ilorin, Kwara State, Nigeria. The event aimed to create awareness about baseball, softball, creative arts, AI and sound character among children aged 7 to 12 from underserved communities in Kwara state, integrating sports with STEAM (Science, Technology, Engineering, Arts, and Mathematics) education. The bootcamp was part of AYBSEF's strategic plan to develop managerial and administrative capacities, create awareness, address infrastructure deficits, and foster capacity development.

The strategic plan aims to train at least 3000 kids in Kwara state which is to be carried out in phases. The first phase, which is the awareness creation stage aimed to train 80 kids in which 60 participants registered. The registered 60 participants were divided into three age groups (7-8, 9-10, and 11-12). The first week focused on teaching Baseball and Softball fundamentals drills like throwing and catching, along with sessions on sound character development. The children also received introductory lessons on artificial intelligence (AI), emphasizing the importance of AI in daily life. The second week featured advanced baseball drills, pitching, base running, continued AI education, sound character roleplay and creative arts activities.

The event concluded with a baseball friendly match among teams, where awards and scholarships were presented to outstanding participants. With the aim of reaching out to 80 participants in the first phase of the training as a means of creating awareness on baseball and softball, substantial number of kids (60 participants) registered. The targeted number of kids not met is likely due to factors like economic challenges, location, and limited interest in baseball. Nonetheless, the event successfully introduced baseball to the community and laid the groundwork for future participation. The kids' performance was monitored throughout the camp, with a notable percentage showing significant progress in both baseball and the supplementary activities.

2.0

INTRODUCTION

Baseball is a bat-and-ball sport played between two teams of nine players, each taking turns batting and fielding. It is a game involving every member of the team as they are all required to participate in determining the success of their team in winning or losing. However, in Nigeria, baseball which is alternatively called softball unlike other sports like football is not recognized and played by youths. Baseball was introduced in Nigeria in the year 1960 by the American Peace Corps but also ended when a civil war broke in 1966 and the America Peace Corps that brought the game to the country was forcefully asked to leave the country. The game, baseball, was later re-introduced in 1989 after the civil war when a group of Nigerians gathered together to form the sports federation called the Nigeria Baseball and Softball Association (NBSA). Since 1989, the association has arranged much competition ranging in 3 main age categories in both baseball and softball enjoying strong participation from the team in different cities of the federation. The age categories are under 12 years, under 16 years and also senior players above the age of 16 years. This is to ensure the continuous involvement of teenagers and youths in baseball game and prevention of extinction of the game in the country.

Despite the continuous efforts of this association, baseball is yet faced with lots of constraints like poor managerial and administrative capacity to effectively support the game with right technology needed, inadequate and low level of awareness in the country and most importantly, lack of adequate support and sponsorship to create awareness and to sustain the penetration and retention of the game in Nigeria.

In view of this, The African Youth Baseball and Softball Empowerment Foundation (AYBSEF) in line with its mandate to inaugurate a vibrant and sustainable Baseball and Softball ecosystem in Nigeria/Africa by providing comprehensive support, access to quality facilities, and training programs, fostering talent, and cultivating a culture of excellence that produces world-class athletes was established and registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission, Nigeria to serve as a pathway for teenagers and youths to participate in baseball sport.

In order to achieve this mandate, a four strategic plan was initiated by AYBSEF which are Strategies for Managerial & Administrative Capacity Development, Strategies for Awareness Creation and Branding, Strategies for Addressing Infrastructure Deficits, and Strategies for Capacity Development. These strategies are followed duly and thus birthed a two-weeks bootcamp tagged “Kids’ Baseball, Softball and STEAM Summer Camp 2024” which is mainly to fulfill the strategic plan for capacity development having the sub strategy of integrating sports with STEAM and sound character for children aged 6-15 years. The event aimed to train 250 kids from underserved communities ensuring the children are registered though their schools. The event took place at Baseball Park Adewole, Ilorin, Kwara State and lasted for two weeks between 12th to 23rd of August, 2024 within the hours of 9am to 12pm daily.

3.0

OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the bootcamp training is to create awareness on baseball sport among teenagers from the age range of 7 to 12 years and also youths in underserved communities in Kwara State. Specifically, the training aims to:

- Train the kids on fundamentals of baseball and games;
- Introduce trainings on AI;
- Train and to mentor the kids on creative arts;
- Teach and ensure the kids embrace the need for sound character in their immediate environment.

4.0

SNAPSHOT OF DAILY ACTIVITIES

Day 1 – Day 3

Day 4 – Day 6

4.0

SNAPSHOT OF DAILY ACTIVITIES

Day 7 – Day 9

Last Day

5.0

OVERVIEW OF THE EVENT

The training started on the 12th to 23rd August, 2024 and lasted for two weeks. At the onset of the training, the kids were registered and given identification tags for security and safety protocols and also to ensure proper tracking and monitoring of the kid.

At the end of registration, 60 kids were recorded to have registered for the training. The kids were grouped into 3 categories based on their age i.e. ages 7 to 8, 9 to 10 and 11 to 12. The first week started with the kids introduced to the main event which is baseball sport by their coaches. During the baseball training, the kids had some infield drills like throwing, catching.

This was followed alongside with teachings on sound character. Some of the topics taught on sound character are: Before you build your wardrobe, build your character, Sound character gives fragrance to your life etc. This was to ensure that the kids do not side line the need to inculcate acceptable habits in their environment and to facilitate behavioral changes.

Towards the end of the first week, the kids were introduced fundamentals of AI. The kids were taught on what AI is all about, its usefulness and significance in our day-to-day activities. This enables the kids to appreciate better the inclusion of AI in their daily activities.
The second week marks the introduction of the kids to some advance baseball fundamental drills like hitting and pitching. The AI class was wind up the second week on the topics AI Robots and Smart Helpers. This enables the kids to see opportunities available should they choose AI and Robotics as career path.
This was coupled with the fun filled activity of creative arts. During the creative art, the kids were exposed to different arts available to divulge into. They were also able to make some artistic drawings of baseball bat, softball and glove which was also painted at the end of the class.

The last day of the event marks the highlight of the event. On this day, the kids were grouped into four teams and each team was tagged Coach Farounbi, Coach Bilkis, Coach Lateefah and Coach Segun respectively. The kids had a fairly match game which in turn boosted their competitiveness and serve as a means of ensuring team work among them. The end of the game was followed by presentation of awards and scholarship to the kids that performed excellently in the activities during the training. The overall best kids were given scholarship to pay their school fees for a term and they were also awarded the gift of bag. The kids that excelled in other courses of the event like sound character, robotics and AI, baseball were awarded various gifts. Some of the gifts include T-shirts, caps, writing boards among many others. All of the participants were awarded certificate of attendance.

The whole event came to an end with a mini party anchored by the volunteers. All of the participants were awarded certificate of attendance.

5.0

OVERVIEW OF THE EVENT

6.0

MONITORING AND EVALUATION

With the target to train 3000 kids in phases within the age range of 7 to 12 years from different schools in underserved communities in Ilorin, Kwara State, the first phase aims to reach out to 80 kids in which only 60 kids (24%) of the target participated in the baseball, softball, mathematics, sound character and creative art training. In total, 8 schools registered their kids for the training. The names of the schools are Federal Staff Secondary School, Seat of Mercy Academy, Alwajud the Light Academy, Boye Schools, Bright Star College, Madi Junior Secondary School, Science Primary School and Topmost School.

Of the registered kids, 51.7% are male while the remaining percentage i.e. 48.3% are female. The disparity in percentage of gender registered could chiefly be attributed to the fact that the sport is perceived to be physically engaging like football and also is seen as a “male-sport”. Based on the age range targeted i.e. 7 to 8, 9 to 10 and 11 to 12, the number of kids that registered are 18, 36 and 4 respectively. Averagely, the age of the participants falls between 11 to 12 years. This portrays the interest of teenagers in baseball sport. The number of kids registered based on the age range is represented in the chart below.

Among all the participants trained for baseball, creative art, sound character and AI, 5% (i.e. 3 out of 60) of them namely Toye Victor, Egwu Emmanuella and Hassan Olojoku emerged excellently as the overall best. At the end of the training, 80% of the participants have successfully been able to play baseball as a beginner and can now proceed to the intermediate level given the chance to. The participants were assessed weekly based on their knowledge in what they had been taught on creative art, sound character, AI and also on their physical involvement on the field. Based on this assessment, the table below shows the names of the outstanding participants in all these activities.

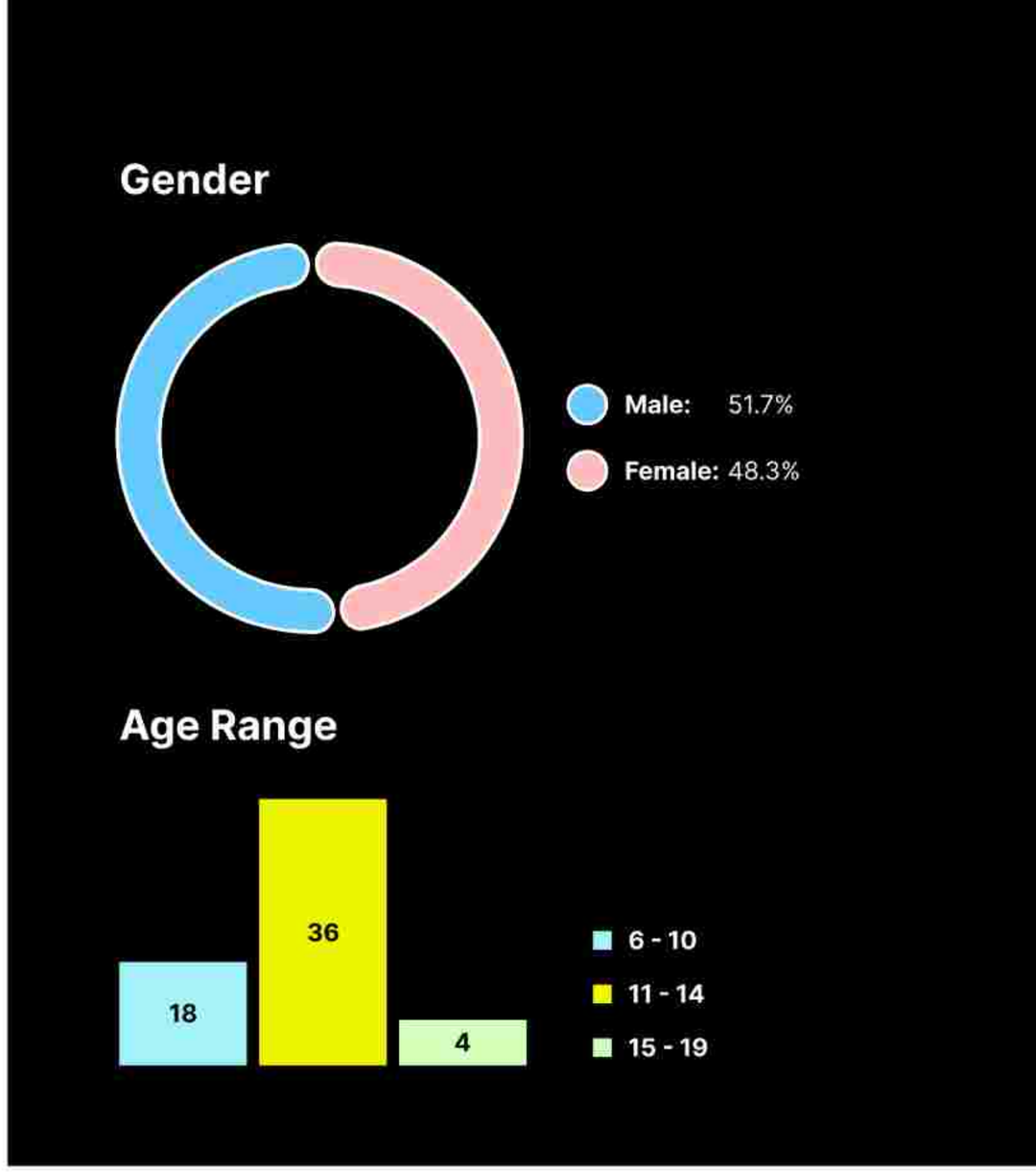


Table 1 **NAMES OF PARTICIPANTS THAT PERFORMED EXCELLENTLY**

ACTIVITIES	NO OF PARTICIPANTS	NAMES
BASEBALL	3	• YAKUBU KEKU • ABDULRAUF AMINAT • ABDULAZEEZ UBAIDAH
CREATIVE ARTS	3	• YAKUBU KEKU • ALARO FAREEDAH • OMOLALE EMMANUEL
SOUND CHARACTER	5	• LUQMAN RIHANAT • MUSA ABDULMAJEED • AMINU ESTHER • MUSTAPHA HASSANAT • LAWAL NURIYA
ARTIFICIAL INTELIGENCE	2	• EGWU EMMANUELLA • ALARO FAREEDAH

7.0

LEARNINGS

The event was able to bring into limelight baseball as a sport and a game that can be played by all and sundry. Selected schools in underserved communities in Ilorin, Kwara State were invited and most of them honoured the invitation and participated in the training. Although, the event aimed to train 80 kids from underserved communities to meet the strategic plan of creating awareness in the first phase, only 60 kids were able to register for the training. This may likely be due to the present economic situation of the country, proximity of the venue to where the kids live, and low interest in baseball game etc. Subsequently, it is believed that the number of kids would be more as the event served as a means of creating awareness to youths and teenagers on baseball and softball sport in the state.

8.0

TRAINING TEAM

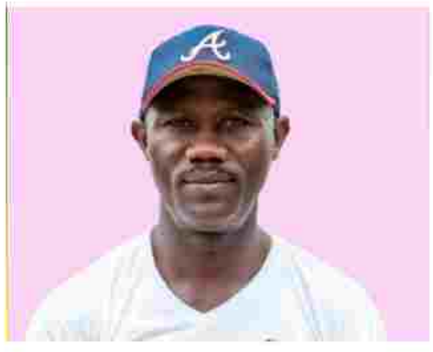
S/N	NAMES	ROLES
1	Eng. Wole Farounbi	
2	ADEKUNLE FAROUNBI	
3	LATEEFAH MUHAMMED	
4	EMMANUEL KOLAWOLE	
5	BILKIS ALLI	
6	SEGUN BABAFEMI	
7	IYABO YUSUF	
8	KAFAYAH ADESOYE	
9	ELEGBE TOBA	
10	KAYODE OLUAYO	
VOLUNTEERS / INSTUCTORS		
11	OGUNDERO IDRIS	LOGISTICS
12	LAWAL OMOTOLA MARIAM	SOUND CHARACTER INSTRUCTOR
13	ADEBAYO IFEDUN DEBORAH	SOUND CHARACTER INSTRUCTOR
14	OJIBARA FARIDAH OMOWUNMI	SOUND CHARACTER INSTRUCTOR
15	OLANIYAN ABIMBOLA	SOUND CHARACTER INSTRUCTOR
16	ADEYEMI OLUWASEUN	SOUND CHARACTER INSTRUCTOR
17	EGWU KELECHUKWU KINGSLEY	MATHEMATICS INSTUCTOR
18	ISHOLA ABDULAZEEZ KAYODE	MATHEMATICS INSTUCTOR
19	ABDULRAHMAN ABDULSALAM DAMILARE	AI INSTUCTOR
20	NERRY ASYNCRITE KOUKOUI	AI INSTUCTOR
21	ADENIYI BELLO	PHOTOGRAPHER

9.0

VOLUNTEERS AND COACHES

VOLUNTEERS

COACHES



10.0

Gallery

Participants before the pictures